

Friday, 3 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

26° 15°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

25° 14°

MANCHESTER

Overcast

21° 14°

GLASGOW

Light rain

17° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Two teenage boys who raped young girls have now been given custodial sentences, after initially avoiding jail.

The decision to give non-custodial sentences for such serious crimes sparked widespread public outrage. This new ruling means the boys will now serve time in youth detention. It's a significant development in a case that has drawn national attention.

CRIME · UK

2

A police officer who raped two women and abused a third has been jailed for 10 years for his horrific crimes.

Cameron Ross carried out attacks in Stornoway between 2012 and 2014, before abusing another woman in Inverness. The court heard the abuse continued for several years. This case highlights a serious breach of trust.

CRIME · UK

3

An exam board has apologised after delays to this year's SATs results for primary school children in England.

School leaders are now demanding 'cast-iron assurances' that the final results will be accurate. The delay has caused significant stress for schools and parents. It's a frustrating situation for everyone involved.

EDUCATION · UK

4

An attempted murder arrest has been made after a 16-year-old boy was shot and remains in a critical condition.

A 17-year-old is now in custody following the incident. Police are continuing their investigation into the shooting. Our thoughts are with the young boy and his family.

CRIME · UK

5

Labour 'failed to prepare for power', according to a former top aide to the Prime Minister.

In his first interview, Morgan McSweeney admitted the party didn't deliver quickly enough once in office. It's a candid admission from someone at the heart of government. This could spark quite a debate.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 All eyes are on New York this weekend as speculation mounts about Taylor Swift's rumoured wedding celebrations.

The pop superstar and Travis Kelce have kept quiet about their nuptials, but stars like Graham Norton and Phoebe Waller-Bridge have been spotted arriving. Madison Square Garden is rumoured to be the venue for a multi-day party. It's set to be the celebrity event of the year!

ON AIR – Are you a Swiftie? What's your favourite Taylor Swift song to get the party started?

CELEBRITY · THIS WEEKEND

2 Madonna has finally released her 15th studio album, 'Confessions II', after a 21-year wait!

The pop icon's latest offering reportedly starts on the dancefloor before delving into deep personal revelations. Fans have been eagerly anticipating this release for decades. It's a huge moment for music lovers.

ON AIR – What's your all-time favourite Madonna track? The one that always gets you moving?

MUSIC · NEW RELEASE

3 Tens of thousands of people are rushing for tickets to see the Bayeux Tapestry in the UK for the very first time!

The historic masterpiece is set to travel from France to go on display on British soil. It's an incredible opportunity to see such a significant piece of history. Demand is expected to be huge!

ON AIR – Have you ever seen the Bayeux Tapestry? Or is there another historical artifact you'd love to see up close?

EXHIBITION · COMING SOON

4 A theatre in London's West End, the Duke of York's, is being renamed after the acclaimed playwright Sir Tom Stoppard.

It's a huge honour for the celebrated writer, known for works like 'Rosencrantz and Guildenstern Are Dead'. The theatre will now be known as the Sir Tom Stoppard Theatre. A fitting tribute to a theatrical legend!

ON AIR – What's your favourite play or playwright? Is there a theatre that holds special memories for you?

THEATRE · COMING SOON

5 The TV show 'Great Canal Journeys' is really a 'love story', according to actor Samuel West.

He was unveiling a plaque to his parents, Timothy West and Prunella Scales, who starred in the popular series. It's a lovely insight into the personal connection behind the much-loved programme. A heartwarming story.

ON AIR – Do you enjoy a good canal journey? Or what's your favourite travel show that inspires you to explore?

TELEVISION · NOSTALGIA

On the schedule

1 **England were just 15 minutes away from a World Cup 'humiliation' before their last-16 tie against Mexico.**

BBC Sport's Phil McNulty has been looking at the issues Thomas Tuchel must solve for the team. It sounds like there are some big talking points. What do you think the manager needs to do?

ON AIR – What changes, if any, do you think Thomas Tuchel should make for the next game?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Iga Swiatek has earned an 'A+ verdict' from tennis legend Martina Navratilova after her latest Wimbledon win.**

Swiatek overpowered former finalist Karolina Pliskova to continue her title defence, reaching the third round in straight sets. She's looking in formidable form on the grass. Could this be her year?

ON AIR – Who are you backing for the Wimbledon titles this year? Any dark horses you're keeping an eye on?

TENNIS · UK

3 **British wildcard Arthur Fery has reached the third round of Wimbledon for the first time in his career!**

He fought back to defeat Otto Virtanen in a thrilling match. It's a fantastic achievement for the young Brit. What a performance on home soil!

ON AIR – How good is it to see British players doing well at Wimbledon? Does it make you want to pick up a racket?

TENNIS · UK

4 **Lewis Hamilton says Silverstone will be 'a completely different circuit' with this year's new F1 cars.**

The Ferrari driver shared his thoughts ahead of the British Grand Prix. It sounds like fans could be in for an exciting race. What are you expecting from the weekend?

ON AIR – Are you excited for the British Grand Prix? Who are you hoping will take the chequered flag?

FORMULA 1 · UK

5 **Pubs across the country will be allowed to stay open until 5am for England's World Cup match against Mexico.**

The government had initially said it wouldn't relax licensing laws further for the tournament. It's good news for fans wanting to watch the game. How late will you be staying up?

ON AIR – Will you be staying up late to watch England play Mexico? Or do you prefer to catch the highlights?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that taking a short, brisk walk after a meal could significantly aid digestion.**
Researchers found that even a 15-minute stroll helps to move food through the digestive system more efficiently, potentially reducing bloating and discomfort. So, a post-dinner wander might be just the ticket!
- 2 The trend of 'library lending libraries' is popping up in neighbourhoods, offering free access to household items and tools.**
Instead of buying things you only use occasionally, these community hubs allow you to borrow everything from drills to board games, promoting sharing and sustainability. A brilliant idea for saving money and decluttering!
- 3 Scientists have discovered that plants can 'hear' the sound of water and grow their roots towards it.**
This fascinating ability helps plants seek out essential moisture, even before direct contact. It seems our green companions are even more clever than we thought!
- 4 The joy of 'retro baking' is making a big comeback, with classic recipes like Victoria sponge and Bakewell tarts seeing a resurgence.**
People are finding comfort and nostalgia in traditional bakes, often passed down through generations. Time to dust off those old family recipe books!
- 5 A quirky new study reveals that pet owners often 'talk in funny voices' to their furry friends more than they realise.**
From high-pitched baby talk to playful growls, these vocal gymnastics are a common, often unconscious, way we bond with our animals. Don't worry, you're not alone!
- 6 The simple act of 'doodling' during meetings or phone calls is being hailed as a way to boost creativity and concentration.**
Far from being a sign of distraction, experts suggest that allowing your mind to wander creatively can help process information and generate new ideas. So, grab a pen and paper!
- 7 Research shows that 'wearing brightly coloured clothes' can have a positive impact on your mood and outlook.**
Opting for vibrant hues rather than muted tones is thought to bring a sense of cheerfulness and energy to your day. Time to embrace the rainbow!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with our socks when we're folding laundry, even if we know it doesn't really matter?

ANSWER: TRYING TO MAKE SURE THE HEEL AND TOE PERFECTLY LINE UP.

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'mug' that only we are allowed to use for our tea or coffee. What's special about it?

ANSWER: IT JUST 'FEELS RIGHT' IN OUR HAND.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you try a 'new hot drink' that isn't tea or coffee, and it becomes your new favourite?**
Maybe it's a specific herbal infusion, a fancy hot chocolate, or even something unique you discovered on holiday. What's your go-to non-tea/coffee hot beverage that you simply love?
- **We all have those little 'comfort items' that we keep around the house – not necessarily valuable, but they hold a lot of sentimental worth, don't we?**
It could be an old blanket, a worn-out teddy bear, a favourite mug, or a collection of pebbles from a special trip. What's that one item in your home that brings you instant warmth and happy memories?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a 'space junk' problem, with thousands of defunct satellites, rocket parts, and fragments orbiting Earth, posing a risk to active spacecraft.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts grow several inches taller in space because there is no gravity to compress their spines, but they shrink back to their original height upon returning to Earth.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The average person walks the equivalent of three times around the world in their lifetime.
- The world's largest snowflake on record was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, observed in Montana, USA, in 1887.
- Goats have rectangular pupils, which give them a wider field of vision.
- The sound of a 'vuvuzela' (the plastic horn used at sporting events) can be as loud as a chainsaw.
- Polar bears have black skin under their white fur, which helps them absorb heat from the sun.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 to 45 minutes.
- Strawberries are the only fruit that wear their seeds on the outside.

On this day

Day 184 of the year, 181 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Anatolius of Constantinople; Christian feast day: Anatolius of Laodicea; Christian feast day: Dathus; Christian feast day: Germanus of Man. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1938 — Rhoda Scott, American soul and jazz Hammond organist
- 1949 — Susan Penhaligon, English actress
- 1940 — Michael Cole, American actor (died 2024)
- 1958 — Siân Lloyd, Welsh meteorologist and journalist
- 1952 — Carla Olson, American singer-songwriter and music producer
- 1980 — Olivia Munn, American actress and television host
- 1956 — Montel Williams, American talk show host and television personality
- 1946 — Johnny Lee, American singer and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1973 — David Bowie retires his stage persona Ziggy Stardust with the surprise announcement that it is "the last show that we'll ever do" on the last day of the Ziggy Stardust Tour.
- 1886 — Karl Benz officially unveils the Benz Patent-Motorwagen, the first purpose-built automobile.
- 1952 — The Constitution of Puerto Rico is approved by the United States Congress.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1952 — The SS United States sets sail on her maiden voyage to Southampton. During the voyage, the ship takes the Blue Riband away from the RMS Queen Mary.
- 1938 — World speed record for a steam locomotive is set in England, by the Mallard, which reaches a speed of 125.88 miles per hour (202.58 km/h).

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2006 — The Valencia Metro derailment kills 41 people.
- 1898 — A Spanish squadron, led by Pascual Cervera y Topete, is defeated by an American squadron under William T. Sampson in the Battle of Santiago de Cuba.

- 1913 — Confederate veterans at the Great Reunion of 1913 reenact Pickett's Charge; upon reaching the high-water mark of the Confederacy they are met by the outstretched hands of friendship from Union survivors.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 185 of the year, 180 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Antoine Daniel; Christian feast day: Andrew of Crete; Christian feast day: Bertha of Artois; Christian feast day: Blessed Catherine Jarrige. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1931 — Stephen Boyd, Northern Ireland-born American actor (died 1977)
- 1924 — Eva Marie Saint, American actress
- 1950 — David Jensen, Canadian-English radio and television host
- 1952 — John Waite, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1952 — Carol MacReady, English actress
- 1938 — Bill Withers, American singer-songwriter and producer (died 2020)
- 1966 — Ronni Ancona, Scottish actress and screenwriter
- 1943 — Alan Wilson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 1970)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1961 — On its maiden voyage, the Soviet nuclear-powered submarine K-19 suffers a complete loss of coolant to its reactor. The crew are able to effect repairs, but 22 of them die of radiation poisoning over the following two years.
- 1976 — Israeli commandos raid Entebbe airport in Uganda, rescuing all but four of the passengers and crew of an Air France jetliner seized by Palestinian terrorists.
- 2001 — Vladivostok Air Flight 352 crashes on approach to Irkutsk Airport killing all 145 people on board.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1054 — A supernova, called SN 1054, is seen by Chinese Song dynasty, Arab, and possibly Amerindian observers near the star Zeta Tauri. For several months it remains bright enough to be seen during the day. Its remnants form the Crab Nebula.
- 2025 — The Oasis Live '25 tour began in Principality Stadium, Cardiff, ending a 16 year hiatus.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)